

Guitar Scale Practice Routine

A 15-minute daily routine on A minor pentatonic box 1, 5th position. Standard tuning (E A D G B e), no capo.

The box: string 6 frets 5 and 8 · strings 5, 4 and 3 frets 5 and 7 · strings 2 and 1 frets 5 and 8. Index finger on fret 5, ring finger on fret 7, little finger on fret 8 — the same fingering every time.

Block A — the position, slowly

5 min

Ascend and descend the whole box at one comfortable, clean tempo. Pick a speed at which every note rings; do not raise it inside this block.

e -----5--8--	e 8--5-----
B -----5--8--	B -----8--5--
G -----5--7--	G -----7--5--
D -----5--7--	D -----7--5--
A -----5--7--	A -----7--5--
E 5--8-----	E -----8--5--

Watch: the fingering never changes, even when you get tired. If a finger substitutes itself, slow down.

What needed attention:

Block B — string crossings, same position

5 min

Loop the two crossings on their own, strings 4–3 then 3–2, with strict alternate picking (down on the first note of each string, up on the second).

e -----	e -----
B -----	B -----5--8--5--8--
G -----5--7-----5--7--	G 5--7-----5--7-----
D 5--7-----5--7-----	D -----
A -----	A -----
E -----	E -----

Watch: keep the pick close to the strings through the change. A hiccup in a pentatonic run is almost always a crossing, not a finger.

What needed attention:

Block C — short phrases, with pauses

5 min

Same notes, used as music. Play a phrase of three to five notes, stop, listen, then answer it. Over an A minor drone or backing track if you have one; unaccompanied is fine, and the silence counts as part of the phrase.

e -----5--
B ----5--8----
G -7-----
D -----
A -----
E -----

That is one example, not the exercise — write your own and end them on different notes of the box.

What needed attention:

Blocks A + B + C = 15 minutes. You choose the tempo; there is no pass mark on this sheet.

From **Riff Quest** — <https://riff.quest/guitar-scale-practice-routine>

Play these three drills with an interactive tab:

Block A — <https://riff.quest/guitar-scale-practice-routine#pentatonic-box1-up-down>

Block B — <https://riff.quest/guitar-scale-practice-routine#pentatonic-string-crossing-3>

Any other scale or position — <https://riff.quest/guitar-scale-practice-routine#scale-practice-configurable>

Practice log — seven sessions

Fill this in by hand after each session. Nothing here is measured for you: the minutes and the tempo are whatever you decide they were.

Date	Exercise / block	Minutes	Tempo	What I noticed

After seven sessions

- Which block do you avoid? That is usually the one paying the most.
- Did the same note buzz on more than three days? Fix the hand position, not the tempo.
- If every session read "fine", the tempo has been too safe.

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Prefer to keep the log digitally? Riff Quest records a session when you log it at <https://riff.quest/report> and shows the history at <https://riff.quest/practice-log>.